CHAPTER FOUR

Israelophobia Is the New Antisemitism

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One of the more puzzling phenomena surrounding antisemitism nowadays is the way European leaders express astonishment at its resurgence. With disappointed and angry faces, they ask, in their speeches condemning antisemitic attacks, "How could all of this happen to us? To us, who swore to banish the hatred against Jews forever; who, with kippahs on our heads, visited the memorials for Jews killed in the Holocaust; who promoted education about the Holocaust in schools; who have paid visits to the Jewish communities in their own synagogues?" British, French, Italian, and German leaders condemned the antisemitic attacks that occurred during the anti-Israel protests of July 2014 with the same incredulity and indignation. In that month it was possible to to witness daily murderous acts of vandalism against the Jews, processions chanting "Death to the Jews," desecration of Jewish cemeteries, acts of vandalism against Jewish property, and physical assaults on rabbis and religious Jews. European leaders' speeches always repeat that the local Jewish community is a pillar of the country, that the history of the Jews is intermingled with that of the other citizens, and most importantly, that Europe has learnt the lessons of history.

Cultivating the memory of the Holocaust in ceremonies, educational curricula, and public debates has long been considered the primary measure to combat antisemitism. But new developments show us that these choices are obsolete. This is because even when antisemitism uses the same traditional stereotypes, formulates blood libels and accusations about Jews dominating the world, it is still essentially aimed at Israel—the collective Jew. Indeed, the new shape of antisemitism mostly instigates hatred against the Jewish State—what I now prefer to call "Israelophobia." This antisemitism must be fought beyond taking European young people to visit Auschwitz. Rather, we must invite high school and college students to visit Israel and to learn about its reality and history which currently they tend to completely misunderstand.

"Culture" and "Memory," according to the basic manual to combat antisemitism, are the main instruments: but about what culture and which history

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